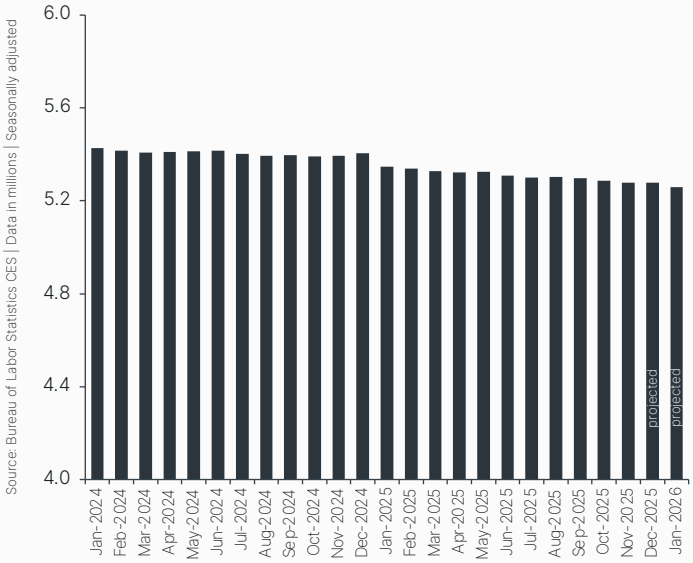
CompTIA

Tech Jobs Report

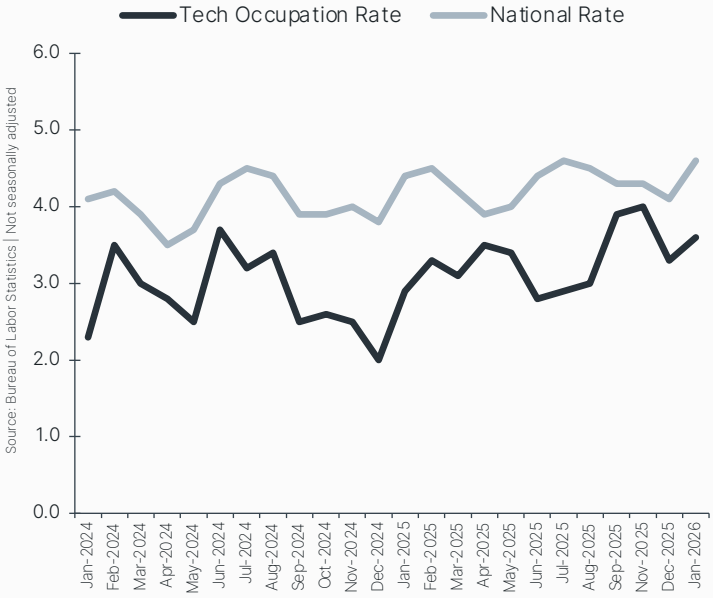
#JobsReport

February 2026 release

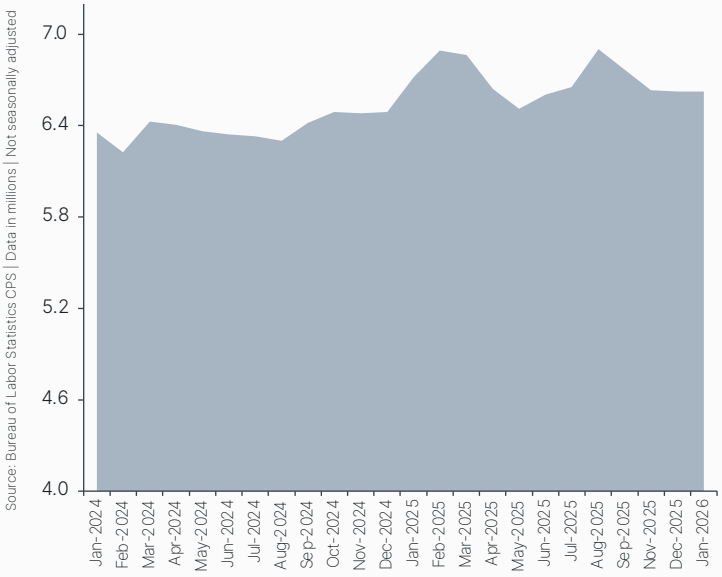
TECH INDUSTRY EMPLOYMENT



UNEMPLOYMENT RATE TRENDING



TECH OCCUPATION EMPLOYMENT



TECH INDUSTRY EMPLOYMENT | TECH JOB POSTINGS

Source: Bureau of Labor Statistics | CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data

	JAN	vs. DEC
TECH SECTOR EMPLOYMENT		
PC, Semiconductor, Components Mfg.	989,000	-200
Telecommunications	584,100	-15,000
Cloud Infrastructure, Data Processing, Hosting	468,100	-4,300
Other Info Services, Search, Platforms	178,400	-2,400
IT & Custom Software Services | Sys. Design	2,380,000	+800
TECH JOB POSTING ACTIVITY		
Software Developer / Engineer	46,001	+4,795
Systems Engineer	19,903	+4,339
Tech Support Specialist	13,757	+1,114
Cybersecurity Engineer / Analyst	12,237	+2,416
Artificial Intelligence Engineer	8,765	+1,353

Data note: due to the government shutdown, the BLS did not publish a full report for the month of October; gaps in the data series for certain charts will exist.

Note: there are certain limitations in using monthly data from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. Not all information technology occupation and industry categories are available on a monthly basis so this data should be viewed as a proxy. Additionally, there tends to be higher levels of volatility and variance in monthly data, so CompTIA advises viewing workforce trends over a longer period of time. The net of tech industry and tech occupation employment equates to net tech employment, as defined by CompTIA. Backward revisions to prior month's data may occur from the sources used in this report. non-seasonally adjusted unemployment rate as defined by the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics captures individuals actively looking for work in the past four weeks. Furloughed workers may have an expectation for returning to their employer and therefore are not actively looking and not counted in unemployment rate figures. For questions related to the data or methodology, please contact the CompTIA Research Team at research@comptia.org.

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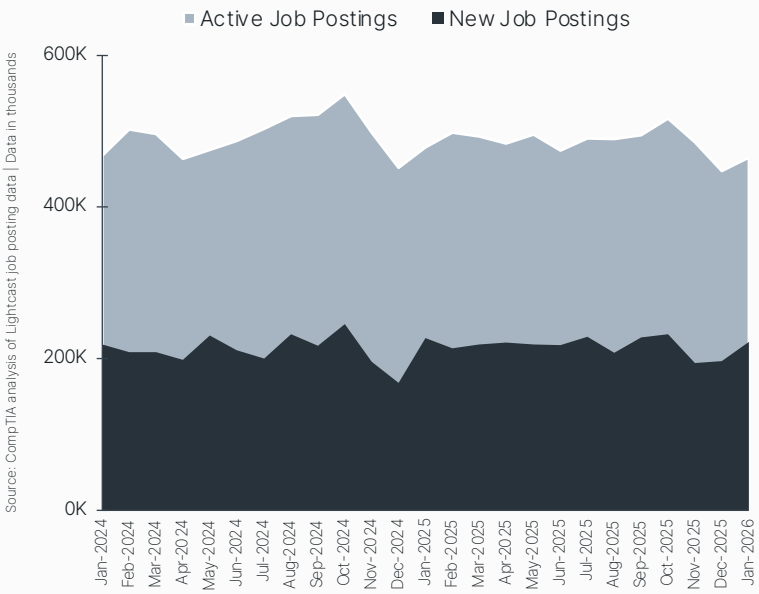
TECH OCCUPATION JOB POSTING VOLUMES



Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data | Data in thousands

TOP REMOTE TECH JOB POSTINGS

	JAN	vs. DEC
Software Developer / Engineer	12,645	+2,791
Systems Engineer / Architect	5,199	+1,546
Tech Support Specialist	2,916	+189
Cyber Security Engineer / Analyst	3,140	+728
Artificial Intelligence Engineer	2,231	+196
Database Architect	1,716	+584
IT Project Manager	1,880	+676
Network Engineer / Architect	2,115	+233
Technology Consultant	1,128	+29
Data/Data Mining Analyst	1,861	+463
SUBTOTAL	34,831	+7,435

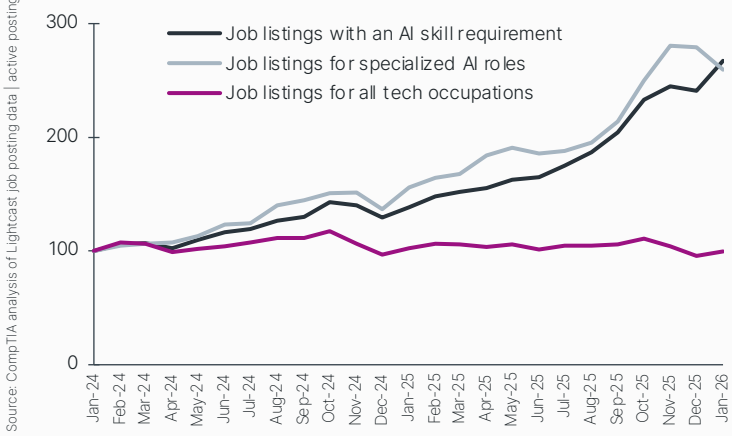
Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data | new postings

TOP REMOTE METROS: TECH JOB POSTINGS

	JAN	vs. DEC
Washington DC	2,605	+534
New York	2,390	+198
Dallas	1,929	+588
Boston	1,850	+317
San Francisco	1,672	+608

AI HIRING INTENT INDEX

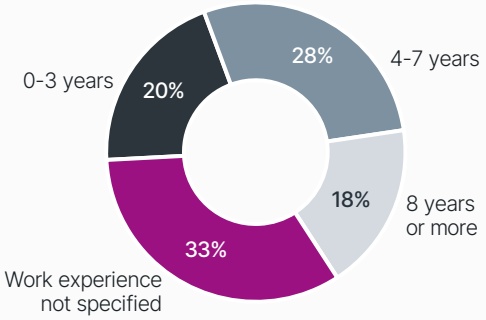
100-point index | base period = Jan 2024



Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data | active postings

TECH HIRING BY YEARS OF EXPERIENCE

Percent distribution of employer job postings for the month across specified work experience requirement



TOP TECH JOBS FOR < 4-YR DEGREE

% of active postings not requiring 4-yr degree | % of total	JAN
Network Support Specialists	88%
Tech Support Specialists	73%
Network and Systems Administrators	63%
Web Developer	58%
Database Administrators	52%

HIRING FOR DEDICATED AI JOB TITLES

Artificial intelligence and machine learning positions	JAN
New York	7%
San Jose	6%
San Francisco	5%
Washington DC	5%
Dallas	4%

Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data

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TOP STATES: TECH JOB POSTINGS

	JAN	vs. DEC
California	24,313	+2,458
Texas	19,394	+1,747
Virginia	12,138	+1,477
New York	10,010	+653
Illinois	8,992	+742
Florida	8,187	+773
Maryland	7,704	+1,838
Massachusetts	7,190	+690
North Carolina	6,779	+892
Georgia	6,401	+919
SUBTOTAL	111,108	+12,189

Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data

TOP STATES: TECH JOB POSTINGS CHANGE

	JAN	vs. DEC
California	24,313	+2,458
Maryland	7,704	+1,838
Texas	19,394	+1,747
Virginia	12,138	+1,477
Ohio	6,209	+1,163
Georgia	6,401	+919
North Carolina	6,779	+892
Florida	8,187	+773
Colorado	4,796	+762
Illinois	8,992	+742
SUBTOTAL	104,913	+12,771

TOP METROS: TECH JOB POSTINGS

	JAN	vs. DEC
Washington DC	13,094	+1,595
New York	12,057	-370
Dallas	8,923	+779
Chicago	6,816	+513
San Francisco	6,789	+1,513
San Jose	6,672	+853
Boston	6,642	+636
Atlanta	5,421	+757
Los Angeles	5,223	-190
Baltimore	4,976	+1,193
Seattle	4,818	+414
Austin	4,218	+196
Philadelphia	3,664	+494
Phoenix	3,552	+51
Houston	3,226	+382
Denver	3,191	+518
Charlotte	3,057	+655
Minneapolis	3,017	+417
Detroit	2,868	+452
Columbus	2,653	+642
SUBTOTAL	110,877	+11,500

Source: CompTIA analysis of Lightcast job posting data

TOP METROS: TECH JOB POSTINGS CHANGE

	JAN	vs. DEC
Washington DC	13,094	+1,595
San Francisco	6,789	+1,513
Baltimore	4,976	+1,193
San Jose	6,672	+853
Dallas	8,923	+779
Atlanta	5,421	+757
Charlotte	3,057	+655
Columbus	2,653	+642
Boston	6,642	+636
Denver	3,191	+518
Chicago	6,816	+513
Philadelphia	3,664	+494
Detroit	2,868	+452
Minneapolis	3,017	+417
Seattle	4,818	+414
Houston	3,226	+382
St. Louis	1,892	+320
Boise City	1,154	+284
Kansas City	1,421	+283
Pittsburgh	1,346	+270
SUBTOTAL	91,640	+12,970

TOP INDUSTRIES: TECH JOB POSTINGS

	JAN
Professional, Scientific, and Technical Services	58,225
Manufacturing	29,213
Administrative and Support Services	25,083
Finance and Insurance	19,837
Information and Media	17,236

Source: CompTIA analysis Lightcast job posting data | For metro area table, a minimum of 500 job postings was used in the analysis

SECTOR SPOTLIGHT: PUBLIC SECTOR

Top metros for sector hiring of tech roles	JAN
Washington DC	140
Los Angeles	73
Columbia	68
Austin	61
New York	50

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